

Web watch

A lot happened in the world of Facebook and Google this month. We look at Graph Search and features of Chrome 25 beta

App watch

January saw a lot of SOS apps for women's safety gain traction. We take a look at some of them

Of Lumias, Ascends and Xperia Z's

We bring you the latest news from Consumer Electronics Show, which surprisingly saw few smartphone launches. Are phone-makers waiting for MWC?

Since the last time we met, perhaps the biggest change in the Indian market has been the launch of the much-awaited Nokia Lumia 920. Given an MRP of ₹38,999, the Windows Phone 8 device started adorning store shelves in India from mid-January. Further along these pages, you will find our review of the Finnish manufacturer's flagship.

Elsewhere, at CES 2013, some manufacturers showed off their wares, whilst others, like LG, Samsung, and HTC, were surprisingly missing from the scene. Lenovo launched a few Android dual-SIM devices, Huawei filled out its Android and WP8 lineup, with a couple of quad-core devices in tow. The BlackBerry 10 leaks kept coming of course, and at the time of writing, we were still awaiting the BB10 OS and device launch on January 31 – head on over to thinkdigit.com for the latest updates on that front.

Moving sideways, two new entrants have made their motives plain in the smartphone operating system battlefield – Mozilla has announced developer models for its mobile Firefox OS, and Canonical has also declared similar intentions for powering mobile devices with Ubuntu from 2014. Samsung has also said it plans to release the first Tizen phones this year.

Nokia Lumia 920 and 820

Nokia launched its first Windows Phone 8 powered devices in India in January, namely the

Lumia 920 and Lumia 820. The Lumia 920, designed with a polycarbonate shell, comes with a 8.7MP PureView technology-endowed rear camera, coupled with an LED 'pulse burst flash' and 1080p HD video recording at 30 fps. The rear camera features floating lens technology, for optical image stabilization (OIS). A 1.3MP front facing camera with 720p HD video recording capabilities. Read our review for more details.

The 9.9mm-thick Nokia Lumia 820 has an MRP of ₹27,559 and is almost identical on the specs sheet, except for a smaller 4.3-inch 800x480 pixel AMOLED display, and the lack of a PureView camera. It also has a smaller 1,650 mAh battery that's rated to deliver up to 14 hours of talktime, and 330 hours of standby time. Unlike the Lumia 920, it supports a microSD card slot, up to 32GB.

The Lumia 620 was also showcased at the Lumia 920 and 820 launch event. Nokia's Lumia 620 is a 3.8-inch handset with a ClearBlack WVGA display powered by a 1 GHz dual-core processor and 512 MB of RAM and a 5MP camera. Nokia has also conveniently added a microSD card slot that supports up to 64GB of



Nokia Lumia-920

storage. The budget device is due to hit shelves in February.

Huawei's at CES

Huawei was one of the few manufacturers to unveil a range of mobile devices at CES 2013, showing off the 6.1-inch Ascend Mate, the 5-inch Ascend D2 (both of which are Android 4.1 Jelly Bean-based), and its first Windows Phone-powered device, the WP8-based Ascend W1.



Huawei Ascend Mate 1

The Ascend Mate has a 6.1-inch display with a 1280x720 IPS+ display and has a 1.5 GHz Hi-Silicon quad-core processor under the hood combined with 2GB of RAM. It runs on Android 4.1 Jelly Bean straight out of the box and is powered by a 4050mAh battery. It has an 8MP AF rear-facing camera with HDR and 1MP HD front-facing camera for video calls. The device is expected to launch first in the Chinese market, in February.

The Huawei Ascend D2 bears a 5-inch IPS display with a resolution of 1920x1280p and runs on Android 4.1 Jelly Bean straight out-of-the-box. The D2 has Huawei's K3V2 1.5 GHz quad-core CPU along with 2GB of RAM. It has a whopping

13MP BSI rear-facing camera along with a 1.3MP front-facing camera for video calls. It also sports a 3000mAh battery. The device is expected to launch first in China, in late-January.

The Huawei Ascend W1 is a 4-inch phone with an 800-by-480-pixel IPS LCD. Under the hood is a 1.2GHz dual-core Qualcomm Snapdragon S4 MSM8230 processor and Adreno 305 GPU. It isn't super-model thin, at 0.39 inches, but it packs in a 1950mAh battery. At the time of writing, the device has already launched in China.

Sony's Xperia Z and ZL

The Xperia Z was finally unveiled at CES 2013. Sony says that the earliest the phone will hit the markets globally is March 2013. The Xperia ZL will only hit "select markets". Pretty much in line with the rumours, the Xperia Z specs include a Qualcomm Snapdragon S4 Pro APQ8064 quad-core processor clocking in at 1.5GHz, Adreno 320 graphics, 2GB of RAM, a 5-inch 1080p HD TFT display, 13MP Exmor RS camera, 16GB built-in storage with microSD expansion, 2330mAh battery, as well as Clear Audio+, Bravia Reality Display and Bravia Engine2 technology.

The Xperia Z also has water-proof capabilities, up to a depth of 1 metre. The Xperia Z has glass panels on the back and the front, along with plastic covers for all ports on the spines. The Xperia Z will ship with Android Jelly Bean 4.1 out of the box, with a "promised" Android 4.2 Jelly Bean update. 